

Multivariable Calculus Final Project

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1 Construction

1.1 Introduction & Design

For this project, our group chose a cone with radius 30" and height 36" (or 2.5' and 3', respectively). The equation that we used was

$$\frac{x^2}{225} + \frac{y^2}{225} = \frac{z^2}{900},$$

where $x \in [-15, 15]$, $y \in [-15, 15]$, and $z \in [0, 30]$. Our cone was domain-restricted to only positive z values, as it would be physically very difficult to construct a cone that extended into the ground.

1.2 Construction Process

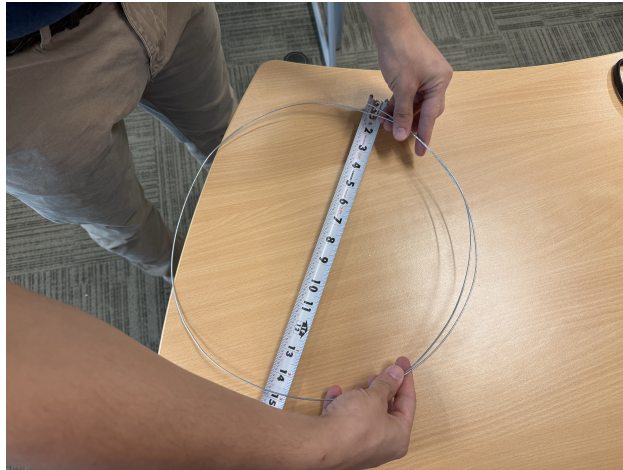
We decided to construct an cone with a peak radius of 15" and a peak height of 30", with the peak radius at the base. To construct the cone, we used wooden sticks to prop up the circles that represented certain radii, and we used metal wire to create those circles.



Diego sawing the wooden support sticks.

The construction process consisted of measuring out the radii for the wire circles and placing the wooden sticks on the outer sides of the cone to then place those wires on. The construc-

tion process required sawing the wooden sticks, which were at first too long, to the proper lengths to fit on the edges, or hypotenuses, approximately 33.5”.



Diego measuring a circle for the cone.

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2 Calculations

2.1 Theoretical Precise Volume

To calculate the theoretical precise value, we will use the triple integral

$$\iiint_Q f(x, y, z) dV.$$

To find the bounds, we will use cylindrical coordinates, as Cartesian coordinates tend to end up messy in such calculations. To find the bounds in cylindrical coordinates, we only need to solve for r , as $\theta \in [0, 2\pi]$ and $z \in [0, 30]$, as given by our domain restrictions above.

To find the bounds for r , we first convert the rectangular x and y to cylindrical coordinates. Following the conversion, our cone can be represented by the equation $\frac{r^2}{225} = \frac{z^2}{900}$, which we can solve to find the upper bound for r :

$$\frac{r^2}{225} = \frac{z^2}{900} \implies r^2 = \frac{225z^2}{900} \implies r = \sqrt{\frac{225z^2}{900}} = \sqrt{\frac{z^2}{4}} = \frac{z}{2}.$$

Thus, the upper bound for r is $\frac{z}{2}$, and because the lower bound for r is 0, we know that the complete bounds for r are $[0, \frac{z}{2}]$. Thus, the complete bounds, for all variables, are:

$$\theta \in [0, 2\pi], \quad z \in [0, 30], \quad \text{and} \quad r \in \left[0, \frac{z}{2}\right].$$

Therefore, we can plug in the bounds and integrand for the triple integral and evaluate it:

$$\begin{aligned} V &= \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^{30} \int_0^{\frac{z}{2}} r \, dr \, dz \, d\theta = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^{30} \left[\frac{r^2}{2} \right]_0^{\frac{z}{2}} dz \, d\theta = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^{30} \frac{z^2}{8} dz \, d\theta \\ &= \int_0^{2\pi} \left[\frac{z^3}{24} \right]_0^{30} d\theta = 1125 \int_0^{2\pi} d\theta = 1125 (2\pi) = 2250\pi \approx 7068.5835. \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the theoretical precise volume of our cone is approximately 7068.5835 cubic inches (or approximately 4.0906 cubic feet).

2.2 Theoretical Approximate Volume

To calculate the theoretical approximate value of the equation $\frac{x^2}{225} + \frac{y^2}{225} = \left(\frac{z^2}{900}\right)$, we must first convert to cylindrical coordinates to find the radius with respect to z , the height. The radius r can be found via the equations:

$$\frac{r^2}{225} = \frac{z^2}{900} \implies r^2 = \frac{z^2}{4} \implies r = \frac{z}{2}.$$

To visualize the Riemann sum, imagine a layer cake with multiple layers that are cylinders of arbitrary h height, and gradually increasing radii. A summation of all the heights of every

layer equates to z , or 30. And, note that there are n cylinders. Additionally, at the peak of the inverted cone, or height 30, the radius is 15, and at the minimum, or height 1 (not including height 0), the radius is $\frac{1}{2}$. Now, for the formal calculation.

Let r be the radius of the partition which is a cylinder, h be the height, z be the height of the original cone, and n be the number of partitions that are taken, specifically referring to the height. The radius, with respect to z , is $r = \frac{z}{2}$. The area of each cylinder's circle is $\frac{z^2}{4}\pi$. Therefore, the area of each partition is $\frac{z^2}{4}h\pi$. Finally, let $\Delta z_0 = \frac{30-0}{n}$, and let $z_i = i\Delta z_0$. Inputting all the values into the Riemann sum and taking the limit of it is as follows:

$$\begin{aligned} V &= \sum_{i=1}^5 [f(z_i)]^2 \pi \Delta z_0 = \sum_{i=1}^5 \frac{z_i^2}{4} \pi \Delta z_0 = \sum_{i=1}^5 \frac{(i\Delta z_0)^2 \pi}{4} \Delta z_0 = \sum_{i=1}^5 \frac{\pi}{4} i^2 \Delta z_0^3 = \sum_{i=1}^5 \frac{\pi}{4} i^2 \frac{30^3}{5^3} \\ &= \sum_{i=1}^5 \frac{\pi}{4} i^2 \frac{27000}{5^3} = \sum_{i=1}^5 \frac{6750\pi}{5^3} i^2 = \frac{6750\pi}{125} (1^2) + \frac{6750\pi}{125} (2^2) + \cdots + \frac{6750\pi}{125} (5^2) \approx 9330.5302 \end{aligned}$$

Thus, the theoretical approximate volume of our cone is approximately 9330.5302 cubic inches (or approximately 5.3996 cubic feet).

2.3 Actual Approximate Volume

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3 Discussion

3.1 Theoretical Precise Volume

Our theoretical precise volume is 7068.5835 cubic inches, and the volume makes sense for the shape that we're planning to construct. Because the volume of the cylinder with $r = 15''$ and $z = 30''$ can be found via the calculations

$$V = \pi r^2 z = \pi 15^2 (30) = \pi 225 (30) = 6750\pi,$$

and the final volume is approximately 21205.7504 cubic inches. The volume of our cone is thus contained in the volume of the cylinder, which is logical and appropriate.

3.2 Theoretical Approximate Volume

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3.3 Actual Approximate Volume

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3.4 Percent Error Calculations

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